



AFTER

The Republican Party exercised increasing power in Congress, but it prepared for the election of 1860 by seeking candidates who could carry the more moderately anti-slavery states it lost in 1856.

A NORTH IS BORN

Republicans tapped into the resentment of Northerners who knew, based on the 1850 census, that they had the majority of the nation's population, wealth, and industry. They used **corruption in [Kansas](#)** and the **Dred Scott decision by the U.S. Supreme Court (see [The Dred Scott case](#))** to raise fears of the spread of slavery throughout the Union.

THE 1860 ELECTION

Four groups competed in the election: the Republican Party, the Constitutional Union Party (which also advocated Union), and the Northern and Southern factions of a now split Democratic Party. The Republicans selected a moderate candidate in **[Abraham Lincoln](#)**, who won without a single electoral vote from the South and without a popular majority (see **[The Election of 1860](#)**).



REPUBLICAN
RIBBON